

Chris Levonas, RHP, Wake Forest

2026 Stats: 2.82 ERA/73.1 IP/1.050 WHIP/116 K/33 BB/3.52 K:BB

6-1, 175

Metrics

FB: 97/18.4 IVB/8.5 HB/-4.26 VAA/6.8 ext/6 relH/37.1% zone/46.1 AA/31% usage/2450 rpm

CT: 88.4/7.1 IVB/-2.9 HB/-6.39 VAA/39.5% zone/41.2 AA/14.4% usage/2420 rpm

CB: 80.2/-12.3 IVB/-11.8 HB/-9.58 VAA/26.7% zone/48.9 AA/27.7% usage/2740 rpm

SL: 84.6/1.2 IVB/-13.5 HB/-7.69 VAA/37.9% zone/43.2 AA/20.9% usage/2630 rpm

CH: 92/7.9 IVB/14.3 HB/-6.39 VAA/21.4% zone/39 AA/6% usage/1910 rpm

Write-up

Chris Levonas possesses one of the cleaner starter profiles in the 2027 class. At 6-foot-5 with long levers, an athletic delivery, and advanced strike throwing, he attacks hitters with a true five-pitch mix that lacks a glaring weakness. Rather than relying on one dominant pitch, Levonas succeeds through sequencing, command, and the ability to consistently present hitters with different movement profiles. His fastball establishes the top of the zone, while four distinct secondaries allow him to attack both handednesses throughout counts. The biggest separator is his polish. Every pitch has a purpose, every offering is thrown with conviction, and there is very little wasted movement throughout the delivery. His command already projects comfortably above average, allowing the arsenal to outperform what the raw movement metrics alone might suggest. There is still room for another half grade of velocity as he continues to mature physically, but even without it the profile already looks like a durable professional starter. The combination of command, durability, and five average-or-better offerings gives Levonas one of the highest floors among collegiate starters entering 2027. There may not be one singular 70-grade weapon outside of the slider's future upside, but there also are very few holes. He presently projects as a mid-rotation starter with legitimate No. 2 upside if one of the breaking balls continues to separate.

The fastball is built around above-average ride, plus velocity, and exceptional command. Sitting 97 mph while touching triple digits, the pitch carries through the top of the zone despite only average raw spin. Levonas consistently works to both sides of the plate and rarely leaks over the middle, allowing the fastball to play above its raw traits. The location plots tell much of the story. Against both righties and lefties he consistently lives in the upper third and on the edges, rarely leaving the ball belt-high over the heart. The pitch generated a solid 22.5% chase rate and nearly 22% whiff rate, numbers that reflect how well he commands the shape rather than overwhelming hitters with raw carry alone. The only limitation is that the movement profile itself is more above-average than elite. There is enough ride and arm-side movement to miss bats, but it is the precision that elevates the pitch. 55/55 pitch

The cutter is one of the more complete pitches in the arsenal. Sitting nearly 89 mph with late depth and enough glove-side movement to separate from the fastball, it gives Levonas a weapon capable of generating both weak contact and swing-and-miss. He consistently locates the pitch down and glove-side to right-handed hitters while also showing confidence in front-dooring and back-dooring lefties. The command is advanced, allowing the cutter to generate over 50% whiffs while avoiding significant damage despite living around the strike zone. The pitch isn't a true bat-missing sweeper nor a hard bullet cutter, it lives comfortably between the two, but the combination of velocity, command, and late finish makes it a legitimate plus professional offering. 55/60 pitch

The curveball is a true power downer that plays exceptionally well off the elevated fastball. Featuring plus vertical depth from a high release, the pitch consistently finishes beneath the zone while maintaining enough velocity to avoid floating into hitters' barrels. It generated over 52% whiffs and nearly 38% CSW while serving as one of his primary put-away offerings. Nearly all of the swing-and-miss came beneath the zone, highlighting both his feel for burying it and the late bite the shape possesses. Unlike many larger breaking balls, Levonas demonstrates enough strike throwing to land it early before expanding late. The command already projects above average and gives the pitch starter utility rather than simply functioning as a chase offering. There are flashes where the curveball looks like his best secondary, and with slightly tighter consistency it could comfortably settle as another plus pitch. 55/60 pitch

The slider is the premier weapon in the arsenal and projects as an impact professional out pitch.

Thrown in the mid-80s with tight sweeper characteristics, the pitch combines late depth with enough sweep to miss bats against both handednesses. The velocity allows it to maintain shape without backing up, while the command consistently places it below the zone or just off the glove-side edge.

The results speak for themselves: over 52% whiffs, more than 25% swinging strikes, and nearly half of all two-strike sliders resulting in punchouts. The whiff plots show remarkable consistency, with virtually every miss occurring in ideal chase locations beneath the strike zone. Perhaps most impressive is the confidence with which Levonas throws it. He shows no hesitation using it in any count and to either handedness, giving the pitch true starter utility rather than platoon dependence. This is already an impact breaking ball and one that projects among the better collegiate sliders entering next season.

65/70 pitch

The changeup is comfortably the least-developed offering but still flashes enough traits to round out the starter profile. Thrown around 91 mph, it features solid velocity separation with modest fade and enough late movement to generate occasional weak contact. The usage remained limited throughout 2026, primarily against left-handed hitters, but the location quality was encouraging. Levonas consistently worked the pitch down and arm-side, allowing it to tunnel effectively off the fastball. The relatively modest swing-and-miss numbers reflect both the limited sample and the fact that it is still more of a contact-management pitch than a true finisher. The ingredients are present for an average future changeup, particularly given the overall strike-throwing ability. As he gains confidence using it against both handednesses, it should become a dependable fifth offering capable of keeping left-handed

hitters honest. 40/50 pitch